BPDR vocal-input study

Independent musical reviewer brief

Version 1.0 | 7 November 2026 | For two reviewers working independently

What we are asking you to do

Listen to short solo hums or sung ideas and compare two versions labelled X and Y. Judge whether the tune, rhythm, rests and expression are preserved, and whether either version contains audible problems introduced by processing.

The target recordings are original melodic ideas lasting 5–15 seconds, often with short notes. Users can hum freely without a score, key or guide melody.

Who can review

We need two adults with practical experience in singing, playing an instrument or teaching music. Please describe your experience and disclose any relationship to the researcher or project. Complete your first ratings independently before discussing them with the other reviewer.

What you will receive

The coordinator will supply a pseudonymous audio packet, neutral trial IDs, an answer sheet and playback instructions. Each trial has X and Y. Some trials also have a clearly labelled reference. Model names, processing labels and the answer key remain with the coordinator until both reviews are returned.

What your judgment establishes

Your ratings provide evidence about audible quality and preservation. A natural free hum can have an unknown intended pitch. Please use “unsure” when the intended melody or a difference cannot be judged. You do not need to invent note names, a key or a cent-accurate pitch target.

Current study status

The review packet and collection schedule still need to be prepared and confirmed. This brief contains instructions and blank fields. No reviewer ratings or participant approvals are claimed. Short-hum pitch repair remains under evaluation.

How to run a review session

Before listening

Use the same headphones and a quiet setting throughout a block. Choose a comfortable volume using the practice clips, then keep it fixed for X and Y. Tell the coordinator if a file is missing, distorted by playback or too quiet to judge. Do not apply an equalizer, pitch correction or separate volume normalization.

For each trial

1. Read the trial ID and whether an external reference is available.
2. If supplied, listen to the reference first. Otherwise, treat the trial as a free-idea comparison.
3. Listen to both complete versions in the supplied order. Replay either version as needed.
4. Fill one form for the trial. Record time ranges for any problems.
5. Submit your independent ratings before discussing them.

Question	How to answer
Overall preference	X / Y / no meaningful difference / unsure. State the reason briefly.
Preservation in X and Y	Rate each version separately for melody, timing/rests and expression. Use preserved / changed acceptably / changed undesirably / unsure.
Audible problems	Examples include clicks, warbling, metallic sound, lost consonants or breath, chopped short notes, shifted rests or uneven level. Record the version and time range.
Closer to an external reference	Answer only when the trial includes an approved reference. X / Y / no meaningful difference / unsure. Otherwise use not applicable.
Suitability for onward melody extraction	For each version, use usable / usable with concerns / rerecord suggested / unsure. Base this on audible evidence and explain concerns.

Session length and breaks

The coordinator should begin with three practice trials and schedule blocks of about 10–15 evaluation trials. Allow roughly 15–25 minutes per block as a planning estimate, including replays and notes. Take breaks or stop whenever needed. The final trial count will be supplied with the packet.

Confidentiality

Use reviewer and trial IDs. Keep recordings and ratings in the storage location supplied by the coordinator. Do not redistribute or upload recordings to other services. Return both your ratings and a list of trials you could not assess.

One-trial rating form

Print or copy one form per trial. Reviewer ID and trial IDs must match the packet.

Identification	Complete before rating
Reviewer ID / date	_____
Trial ID / playback order	_____ / _____
Reference available?	Yes / No Playback problem? Yes / No

Assessment	Version X	Version Y
Melody	Preserved / acceptable change / undesirable change / unsure	Preserved / acceptable change / undesirable change / unsure
Timing and rests	Preserved / acceptable change / undesirable change / unsure	Preserved / acceptable change / undesirable change / unsure
Expression, slides and vibrato	Preserved / acceptable change / undesirable change / unsure	Preserved / acceptable change / undesirable change / unsure
Audible technical problems	None heard / present / unsure	None heard / present / unsure
Suitable to pass onward?	Usable / concerns / rerecord / unsure	Usable / concerns / rerecord / unsure

Overall preference X / Y / no meaningful difference / unsure

Closer to the supplied reference X / Y / no meaningful difference / unsure / not applicable

Confidence in this rating high / moderate / low

Problem time range, version and description

_____

_____

_____

Reason for your preference or uncertainty

_____

_____

A preference alone does not approve a model or permit a repair. The coordinator combines these ratings with the technical evaluation.

Coordinator and academic checklist

This page is for the project owner and university research supervisor. Pages 1–3 can be sent directly to reviewers.

What is needed from the university supervisor

Confirm the study scope and progress rubric when available. Advise which institutional ethics, consent or recording permissions apply, and ensure they are resolved before new participant collection. Confirm storage/access, retention and withdrawal arrangements, plus permission for presentation playback. Review any proposed scope change if free-hum pitch repair cannot meet its qualification requirements.

The project owner can arrange logistics and reviewers. The academic supervisor does not need to supply musical ratings unless separately recruited as a reviewer and any independence concerns are disclosed.

What is needed from each reviewer

A short experience description; availability; agreement to the recording access terms; independent ratings; time-specific descriptions of audible problems; and returned forms including unsure/unassessable trials. Preserve each reviewer's original ratings. Record any later adjudication separately.

Before sending the packet

Use only recordings with appropriate access permissions. Select trials from the declared cohort, including unchanged expressive controls, withholds and repeats. Freeze selection and randomization before ratings. Keep a private answer key and consistent gain for each pair. Check every audio file and trial ID. Supply a return date, contact and approved return location.

For free hums, ask the performer separately whether the output preserves their idea. Reviewers cannot replace that judgment. Guided or controlled detuning trials need their own identified reference. Include their results as a separate evidence group.

Coordinator record	Fill before the first review
Study contact / return location	_____
Reviewer R1 / experience recorded	_____
Reviewer R2 / experience recorded	_____
Institutional clearance / consent status	_____
Storage location / access / deletion date	_____
Packet version / trial count / return date	_____

The existing feasibility plan proposes eight adults with six phrases each, split by person into four development and four confirmation participants. These are planned slots. No recruitment, power calculation or completed review is implied.